

Module 4

UVM Components

Learning objectives

- Build complete UVM agents with driver, monitor, and sequencer

Prerequisites

- See module README

Learning path

Learning Path

Diagram: Learning Path

(render with mmdc when available)

flowchart LR

T1["UVM Agent Architecture"]

T2["UVM Driver Implementation"]

T1 --> T2

T3["UVM Monitor Implementation"]

T2 --> T3

Build complete UVM agents with driver, monitor, and sequencer

Overview

- This module covers the core UVM components used to build verification environments. You'll learn ho...

Syllabus topics

1. UVM Agent Architecture (1/9)

- Agent Overview and Structure
- Agent purpose and responsibilities
- Agent components (driver, monitor, sequencer)
- Agent configuration
- Active vs passive agents
- Agent Components

1. UVM Agent Architecture (2/9)

- Driver for stimulus generation
- Monitor for observation
- Sequencer for sequence management
- Agent integration
- BaseTransaction: Basic transaction with ``data`` and ``address`` fields
- ExtendedTransaction: Extended transaction with ``control`` and ``status`` fields

1. UVM Agent Architecture (3/9)

- ConstrainedTransaction: Transaction with randomization constraints
- Transaction Operations: Copy, comparison, and string conversion
- Purpose: Provide human-readable string representation
- Usage: Debugging, logging, reporting
- Key: Override from ``uvm_object`` base class
- Purpose: Create independent copy of transaction

1. UVM Agent Architecture (4/9)

- Usage: ``txn2.copy(txn1)`` - creates deep copy
- Key: Must call ``super.do_copy(rhs)`` first, then copy all fields
- Purpose: Compare two transactions for equality
- Usage: ``if (txn1.compare(txn2))`` - returns 1 if equal
- Key: Returns 1 if all fields match, 0 otherwise
- Purpose: Generate random values satisfying constraints

1. UVM Agent Architecture (5/9)

- Usage: ``txn.randomize()` - returns 1 if successful
- Key: Constraints ensure protocol compliance
- Purpose: Post-process after randomization
- Usage: Calculate derived fields, validate constraints
- Key: Called automatically after ``randomize()` succeeds
- Example: Calculate expected results, checksums, derived values

1. UVM Agent Architecture (6/9)

- Purpose: Type-safe conversion from ``uvm_object`` to specific type
- Usage: Required in ``do_copy()`` and ``do_compare()``
- Key: Always check return value, handle type mismatch
- Purpose: Extend base transaction with additional fields
- Key: Must call ``super`` methods to handle base class fields
- Transaction class design extending ``uvm_sequence_item``

1. UVM Agent Architecture (7/9)

- Transaction fields and data members
- Transaction copy and comparison operations
- Extended transactions with inheritance
- Constrained random transactions
- ``convert2string()` for debugging and logging
- ``do_copy()` for deep copying transactions

1. UVM Agent Architecture (8/9)

- ``do_compare()` for transaction comparison
- ``randomize()` for constrained random generation
- Constraints ensure protocol compliance
- Transaction creation and initialization
- Transaction copy operations
- Transaction comparison operations

1. UVM Agent Architecture (9/9)

- Extended transaction inheritance
- Constrained random transaction generation

2. UVM Driver Implementation (1/8)

- Driver Purpose and Responsibilities
- Stimulus generation
- Protocol implementation
- Signal driving
- Transaction-to-signal conversion
- Driver Implementation

2. UVM Driver Implementation (2/8)

- Driver class structure
- Sequencer communication
- Transaction reception
- Signal driving patterns
- SimpleDriver: Basic driver implementation with transaction reception
- ProtocolDriver: Protocol-aware driver with handshaking

2. UVM Driver Implementation (3/8)

- Driver-Sequencer Communication: Using ``seq_item_port`` for transaction flow
- Signal Driving: Converting transactions to DUT signals
- Purpose: Get transaction from sequencer (blocking)
- Usage: Called in driver's ``run_phase()`` forever loop
- Key: Blocks until sequencer provides transaction
- Purpose: Signal that transaction processing is complete

2. UVM Driver Implementation (4/8)

- Usage: Called after driving transaction to DUT
- Key: Allows sequencer to provide next transaction
- Purpose: Convert transaction to DUT signals
- Usage: Called after ``get_next_item()`
- Key: Implements protocol-specific driving logic
- Purpose: Implement protocol-specific handshaking

2. UVM Driver Implementation (5/8)

- Key: Handles request/grant, timing, protocol compliance
- Purpose: Connect driver to sequencer
- Usage: In agent's ``connect_phase()`
- Key: Establishes TLM communication channel
- Driver class structure extending ``uvm_driver``
- Transaction reception from sequencer via ``seq_item_port``

2. UVM Driver Implementation (6/8)

- Signal driving to DUT
- Driver-sequencer communication
- Protocol-specific driving patterns
- ``get_next_item()`` - Get transaction from sequencer (blocking)
- ``item_done()`` - Signal transaction completion
- ``drive_transaction()`` - Convert transaction to signals

2. UVM Driver Implementation (7/8)

- TLM connection -
 ``seq_item_port.connect(sequencer.seq_item_export)``
- Forever loop - Driver continuously processes transactions
- Driver creation and initialization
- Transaction reception from sequencer
- Signal driving to DUT
- Protocol-specific driving patterns

2. UVM Driver Implementation (8/8)

- Driver-sequencer communication

3. UVM Monitor Implementation (1/7)

- Monitor Purpose and Responsibilities
- DUT observation
- Signal sampling
- Transaction creation
- Analysis port usage
- Monitor Implementation

3. UVM Monitor Implementation (2/7)

- Monitor class structure
- Signal sampling
- Transaction creation
- Analysis port forwarding
- SimpleMonitor: Basic monitor implementation with signal sampling
- ProtocolMonitor: Protocol-aware monitor with handshake monitoring

3. UVM Monitor Implementation (3/7)

- Transaction Creation: Creating transactions from sampled signals
- Analysis Port: Forwarding transactions via analysis port
- Purpose: Broadcast transaction to all subscribers
- Usage: Called after creating transaction from sampled signals
- Key: Non-blocking, broadcasts to all connected subscribers
- Purpose: Create analysis port in constructor

3. UVM Monitor Implementation (4/7)

- Key: Analysis ports created in constructor, not `build_phase`
- Purpose: Sample DUT signals and create transactions
- Key: Monitor is passive (doesn't drive DUT)
- Purpose: Connect monitor to subscribers (scoreboard, coverage, etc.)
- Key: One monitor can connect to multiple subscribers
- Purpose: Receive transactions from analysis port

3. UVM Monitor Implementation (5/7)

- Usage: Scoreboard, coverage collector, logger
- Key: Automatically called when monitor writes to analysis port
- Monitor class structure extending ``uvm_monitor``
- Signal sampling from DUT
- Transaction creation from sampled signals
- Analysis port usage

3. UVM Monitor Implementation (6/7)

- Protocol-specific monitoring
- ``ap.write(txn)`` - Broadcast transaction to subscribers
- Analysis port creation - In constructor, not `build_phase`
- Signal sampling - Wait for protocol events, sample signals
- Transaction creation - Create from sampled signals
- Subscriber pattern - Components receive via ``write()`` method

3. UVM Monitor Implementation (7/7)

- Monitor creation and initialization
- Signal sampling from DUT
- Transaction creation from signals
- Analysis port forwarding
- Protocol-specific monitoring

4. UVM Sequencer and Sequences (1/8)

- Sequencer Implementation
- Sequencer purpose
- Sequence item management
- Sequence execution
- Sequencer-driver communication
- Sequence Implementation

4. UVM Sequencer and Sequences (2/8)

- Sequence items (``uvm_sequence_item``)
- Sequences (``uvm_sequence``)
- Sequence execution
- Sequence libraries
- SimpleSequence: Basic sequence implementation
- ExtendedSequence: Extended sequence with configurable item count

4. UVM Sequencer and Sequences (3/8)

- Sequence Execution: Starting sequences on sequencers
- Sequence Item Generation: Creating and sending sequence items
- Purpose: Generate and send sequence items
- Usage: Main sequence logic
- Key: Called when sequence is started
- Purpose: Request sequence item from sequencer

4. UVM Sequencer and Sequences (4/8)

- Usage: Called before setting item fields
- Key: Blocking call, waits for sequencer availability
- Purpose: Send sequence item to driver
- Usage: Called after setting item fields
- Key: Item flows: Sequence → Sequencer → Driver
- Purpose: Start sequence execution on sequencer

4. UVM Sequencer and Sequences (5/8)

- Usage: In test's ``run_phase()`
- Key: Sequence executes ``body()` task
- Purpose: Generate random test vectors
- Key: Constraints ensure valid values
- Purpose: Configurable sequence with parameters
- Key: Can be configured via ConfigDB or constructor

4. UVM Sequencer and Sequences (6/8)

- Sequencer implementation
- Sequence items (``uvm_sequence_item``)
- Sequences (``uvm_sequence``)
- Sequence execution
- Sequence libraries
- ``body()`` - Main sequence logic (generates items)

4. UVM Sequencer and Sequences (7/8)

- ``start_item(item)`` - Request item from sequencer
- ``finish_item(item)`` - Send item to driver
- ``seq.start(sequencer)`` - Start sequence execution
- Item flow: Sequence → Sequencer → Driver
- Sequencer creation and initialization
- Sequence item generation

4. UVM Sequencer and Sequences (8/8)

- Sequence execution
- Sequencer-driver communication
- Sequence libraries

5. TLM (Transaction-Level Modeling) (1/8)

- TLM Interfaces
- Put/get interfaces
- Peek interfaces
- Transport interfaces
- Analysis interfaces
- TLM Components

5. TLM (Transaction-Level Modeling) (2/8)

- TLM ports and exports
- TLM FIFOs
- Analysis ports and exports
- TLM connections
- TlmProducer: Uses ``uvm_blocking_put_port`` to produce transactions
- TlmConsumer: Uses ``uvm_blocking_get_export`` to consume transactions

5. TLM (Transaction-Level Modeling) (3/8)

- AnalysisProducer: Uses ``uvm_analysis_port`` to broadcast transactions
- AnalysisSubscriber: Uses ``uvm_subscriber`` to receive transactions
- Purpose: Send transaction to consumer (blocking)
- Usage: Producer sends transactions
- Key: Blocks until consumer receives
- Purpose: Receive transaction from producer (blocking)

5. TLM (Transaction-Level Modeling) (4/8)

- Usage: Consumer receives transactions
- Key: Blocks until producer sends
- Purpose: Buffer between producer and consumer
- Usage: Decouples producer and consumer timing
- Key: FIFO stores transactions temporarily
- Purpose: Broadcast transaction to multiple subscribers

5. TLM (Transaction-Level Modeling) (5/8)

- Usage: One-to-many communication
- Key: Non-blocking, broadcasts to all subscribers
- Purpose: Receive transactions from analysis port
- Usage: Scoreboard, coverage, logger
- Key: Automatically called when producer writes
- TLM interfaces (put, get, peek, transport)

5. TLM (Transaction-Level Modeling) (6/8)

- TLM ports and exports
- TLM FIFOs
- Analysis ports and exports
- TLM connections
- ``put_port.put(txn)`` - Send transaction (blocking)
- ``get_export.get(txn)`` - Receive transaction (blocking)

5. TLM (Transaction-Level Modeling) (7/8)

- ``ap.write(txn)`` - Broadcast transaction (non-blocking)
- ``write(t)`` - Receive in subscriber (automatic)
- TLM FIFO - Decouples producer and consumer
- Analysis port - One-to-many communication
- TLM port/export creation
- TLM connection establishment

5. TLM (Transaction-Level Modeling) (8/8)

- Transaction flow via TLM
- Analysis port broadcasting
- TLM FIFO usage

6. Scoreboards (1/8)

- Scoreboard Purpose
- Result checking
- Transaction comparison
- Pass/fail tracking
- Verification closure
- Scoreboard Implementation

6. Scoreboards (2/8)

- Scoreboard structure
- Transaction storage
- Comparison logic
- Result reporting
- SimpleScoreboard: Basic scoreboard with transaction comparison
- Transaction Storage: Storing expected and actual transactions

6. Scoreboards (3/8)

- Comparison Logic: Comparing transactions for verification
- Result Reporting: Reporting pass/fail counts
- Purpose: Receive transactions from monitor
- Usage: Called automatically when monitor writes to analysis port
- Key: Compares actual vs expected results
- Purpose: Store expected transaction for later comparison

6. Scoreboards (4/8)

- Usage: Called before actual transaction arrives
- Key: Queue stores expected transactions in order
- Purpose: Manage expected transaction queue
- Key: FIFO queue ensures order matching
- Purpose: Compare actual vs expected results
- Key: Reports pass/fail, tracks counts

6. Scoreboards (5/8)

- Purpose: Report final test results
- Usage: Called in cleanup phase
- Key: Provides test pass/fail summary
- Purpose: Connect monitor to scoreboard
- Key: Monitor writes → Scoreboard receives
- Scoreboard purpose and structure

6. Scoreboards (6/8)

- Transaction comparison
- Result checking
- Pass/fail tracking
- ``write(txn)`` - Receive transaction from monitor
- ``add_expected(txn)`` - Store expected transaction
- Queue operations - ``push_back()``, ``pop_front()``,
``size()``

6. Scoreboards (7/8)

- Comparison logic - Compare actual vs expected
- Report phase - Final test results
- Analysis export - ``uvm_analysis_imp`` receives transactions
- Scoreboard creation and initialization
- Transaction storage
- Transaction comparison

6. Scoreboards (8/8)

- Pass/fail tracking
- Result reporting

7. Complete Agent Example (1/6)

- Building Complete Agents
- Agent structure
- Component integration
- Agent configuration
- Active vs passive agents
- CompleteAgent: Contains driver, monitor, and sequencer

7. Complete Agent Example (2/6)

- Agent Configuration: Configurable as active or passive
- Component Integration: Integrating all agent components
- Agent Testing: Testing complete agent functionality
- Purpose: Create agent components based on configuration
- Key: Active agent has driver+sequencer, passive has monitor only
- Monitor: Always created (both active and passive modes)

7. Complete Agent Example (3/6)

- Driver/Sequencer: Only created in active mode
- Purpose: Connect agent components
- Key: Driver-sequencer connection only for active agents
- Note: Monitor analysis port connected in environment's connect_phase
- Purpose: Configure agent as active or passive
- Usage: Set before creating agent

7. Complete Agent Example (4/6)

- Key: Active = driver+sequencer+monitor, Passive = monitor only
- Timing: Must be set in test's build_phase before agent creation
- Purpose: Use agent based on mode
- Key: Check `is\_active` before using driver/sequencer
- Agent structure
- Component integration

7. Complete Agent Example (5/6)

- Agent configuration
- Active vs passive agents
- Active agent - Driver + Sequencer + Monitor
- Passive agent - Monitor only
- Configuration - Via ConfigDB before creation
- Component creation - Based on active/passive mode

7. Complete Agent Example (6/6)

- Connection - Driver-sequencer only for active agents
- Complete agent creation
- Component integration
- Agent configuration
- Active/passive agent modes
- Agent functionality

Hands-on examples

Module 4 self-check

```
$ ./scripts/module4.sh --transactions
```

Module 4 self-check
(run ./scripts/module4.sh when ready)

Exercise scaffold

```
./scripts/module4.sh --scaffold
```

Example 1: Transactions

- BaseTransaction: Basic transaction with ``data`` and ``address`` fields
- ExtendedTransaction: Extended transaction with ``control`` and ``status`` fields
- ConstrainedTransaction: Transaction with randomization constraints

Demo: Transactions

```
$ ./scripts/module4.sh --transactions
```

Terminal: ex01_transactions

```
[0:36m===== [0m
[0:36mModule 4: UVM Components [0m
[0:36m===== [0m

[0:34m[2026-05-28 21:28:20] Log file: /home/yongfu/proj/universal-verification-methodology/lear
[0:34m[2026-05-28 21:28:20] Checking prerequisites... [0m
[0:31m[2026-05-28 21:28:20] Error: verilator not found. Please install it first. [0m
```

Example 2: Drivers

- SimpleDriver: Basic driver implementation with transaction reception
- ProtocolDriver: Protocol-aware driver with handshaking
- Driver-Sequencer Communication: Using ``seq_item_port`` for transaction flow

Demo: Drivers

```
$ ./scripts/module4.sh --drivers
```

Terminal: ex02_drivers

```
[0:36m===== [0m
[0:36mModule 4: UVM Components [0m
[0:36m===== [0m

[0:34m[2026-05-28 21:28:20] Log file: /home/yongfu/proj/universal-verification-methodology/lear
[0:34m[2026-05-28 21:28:20] Checking prerequisites... [0m
[0:31m[2026-05-28 21:28:20] Error: verilator not found. Please install it first. [0m
```

Example 3: Monitors

- SimpleMonitor: Basic monitor implementation with signal sampling
- ProtocolMonitor: Protocol-aware monitor with handshake monitoring
- Transaction Creation: Creating transactions from sampled signals

Demo: Monitors

```
$ ./scripts/module4.sh --monitors
```

Terminal: ex03_monitors

```
[0:36m===== [0m
[0:36mModule 4: UVM Components [0m
[0:36m===== [0m

[0:34m[2026-05-28 21:28:20] Log file: /home/yongfu/proj/universal-verification-methodology/lear
[0:34m[2026-05-28 21:28:20] Checking prerequisites... [0m
[0:31m[2026-05-28 21:28:20] Error: verilator not found. Please install it first. [0m
```

Example 4: Sequencers

- SimpleSequence: Basic sequence implementation
- ExtendedSequence: Extended sequence with configurable item count
- Sequence Execution: Starting sequences on sequencers

Demo: Sequencers

```
$ ./scripts/module4.sh --sequencers
```

Terminal: ex04_sequencers

```
[0:36m=====
[0:36mModule 4: UVM Components
[0:36m=====

[0:34m[2026-05-28 21:28:21] Log file: /home/yongfu/proj/universal-verification-methodology/lear
[0:34m[2026-05-28 21:28:21] Checking prerequisites...
[0:31m[2026-05-28 21:28:21] Error: verilator not found. Please install it first.
```

Example 5: TLM

- TlmProducer: Uses ``uvm_blocking_put_port`` to produce transactions
- TlmConsumer: Uses ``uvm_blocking_get_export`` to consume transactions
- AnalysisProducer: Uses ``uvm_analysis_port`` to broadcast transactions

Demo: TLM

```
$ ./scripts/module4.sh --tlm
```

Terminal: ex05_tlm

```
[0:36m===== [0m
[0:36mModule 4: UVM Components [0m
[0:36m===== [0m

[0:34m[2026-05-28 21:28:21] Log file: /home/yongfu/proj/universal-verification-methodology/lear
[0:34m[2026-05-28 21:28:21] Checking prerequisites... [0m
[0:31m[2026-05-28 21:28:21] Error: verilator not found. Please install it first. [0m
```

Example 6: Scoreboards

- SimpleScoreboard: Basic scoreboard with transaction comparison
- Transaction Storage: Storing expected and actual transactions
- Comparison Logic: Comparing transactions for verification

Demo: Scoreboards

```
$ ./scripts/module4.sh --scoreboards
```

Terminal: ex06_scoreboards

```
[0:36m=====
[0:36mModule 4: UVM Components
[0:36m=====

[0:34m[2026-05-28 21:28:21] Log file: /home/yongfu/proj/universal-verification-methodology/lear
[0:34m[2026-05-28 21:28:21] Checking prerequisites...
[0:31m[2026-05-28 21:28:22] Error: verilator not found. Please install it first.
```

Example 7: Complete Agents

- CompleteAgent: Contains driver, monitor, and sequencer
- Agent Configuration: Configurable as active or passive
- Component Integration: Integrating all agent components

Demo: Complete Agents

```
$ ./scripts/module4.sh --agents
```

Terminal: ex07_agents

```
[0:36m===== [0m
[0:36mModule 4: UVM Components [0m
[0:36m===== [0m

[0:34m[2026-05-28 21:28:22] Log file: /home/yongfu/proj/universal-verification-methodology/lear
[0:34m[2026-05-28 21:28:22] Checking prerequisites... [0m
[0:31m[2026-05-28 21:28:22] Error: verilator not found. Please install it first. [0m
```

Practice & assessment

What you should know (1/2)

- Design and implement transaction classes
- Create drivers for DUT stimulus generation
- Implement monitors for DUT observation
- Build sequencers and sequences for test generation
- Use TLM for component communication
- Create scoreboards for result checking

What you should know (2/2)

- Build complete agents with all components integrated
- Apply UVM component patterns in testbenches

Exercises

- Transaction Modeling
- Driver Implementation
- Monitor Implementation
- Sequencer and Sequences
- TLM Communication

Exercises

- Scoreboards
- Complete Agents

Assessment checklist

- Can design and implement transaction classes
- Can create drivers for DUT stimulus
- Can implement monitors for DUT observation
- Can build sequencers and sequences
- Can use TLM for component communication
- Can create scoreboards for result checking

Summary & next steps

- Build complete UVM agents with driver, monitor, and sequencer
- Complete module4/CHECKLIST.md
- Review module4/EXAMPLES.md and run each lab
- Next: Next module in course